



EXERCISES IN READING COMPREHENSION

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ABSTRACT

IT CONTAINS ONLY THE FIRST PASSAGE
FROM 1-10 SCETION, FEATURING
ELEMENTARY ENGLISH.

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GEEL-1101

Section I

Structural Items: Present of be and have | there is, there are | can
(1C only)

1A. The Pacific Ocean

The Pacific is the largest and deepest ocean in the world. Around it there are the east coasts of Asia and Australasia and the west coast of the American continent. There are oceans to the north and south of the Pacific. To the north there is the Arctic Ocean. To the south there is the Antarctic Ocean, also known as the Southern Ocean.

The greatest breadth of the Pacific Ocean is about 10,000 miles, and its greatest length is 7,000 miles. It has an area of about 63,600,000 square miles, and its greatest known depth is 6¾ miles.

1. Find words in the passage that can complete these sentences:

- a) The Mediterranean is a sea, but the Pacific is an _____.
- b) Our swimming bath is a hundred feet long, fifty feet wide and six feet deep at its deepest point; its _____ is a hundred feet, its _____ is fifty feet and its greatest _____ is six feet.
- c) The forest is ten miles long and five miles wide, so it has an _____ of fifty square _____.
- d) There are six _____: Africa, America, Australasia, Antarctica, Asia and Europe.
- e) 'John was in the middle, and the other boys were standing _____ him.'

2. Answer these questions:

- a) What is the Pacific?
- b) Is it the largest and deepest ocean in the world?
- c) What is its greatest breadth?
- d) What is its area?
- e) What coasts are there to the west of the Pacific?
- f) What coast is there to the east of it?
- g) Is the Arctic Ocean to the north or to the south of the Pacific?
- h) What is the Antarctic Ocean sometimes known as?
- i) What is the greatest depth of the Pacific Ocean?
- j) How many continents are there around it?

3. Answer yes or no to each question:

- a) Is the Mediterranean an ocean?
- b) Is the Pacific Ocean larger than the Arctic Ocean?
- c) Is the greatest breadth of the Pacific about 20,000 miles?
- d) Is it about 10,000 miles?
- e) Is the length of the Pacific greater than its breadth?
- f) Are there the coasts of three continents around the Pacific?
- g) Is Asia an ocean?
- h) Is America a continent?
- i) Are there oceans to the north and south of the Pacific?
- j) Is the Arctic also known as the Southern Ocean?

4. Complete these sentences with there; is, are; or the:

- a) ____ Pacific ____ largest ocean in ____ world.
- b) ____ Antarctic Ocean is also known as ____ Southern Ocean.
- c) ____ greatest known depth of ____ Pacific is $6\frac{3}{4}$ miles.
- d) To ____ south of the Pacific ____ is ____ Southern Ocean.
- e) Around the Pacific ____ the coasts of Asia, Australasia and America.

Section 2

Structural Items: As for Section 1, plus cannot | has to, have to (2C only) only
relative clauses with who and that (2C only)

2A. The Glow-Worm

The glow-worm is an insect. In spite of its name it is not really a worm but a member of the beetle family. It is coloured dark brown on the back and pink underneath. There are two spots of bright red on each division of its body. At night there is a green light in its tail.

The glow-worm hunts a very small kind of snail for food. The glow-worm's method of attack is interesting. It can make the snail unconscious and then feed on it. But the glow-worm cannot really eat. It can only drink. It has to change its food into a drink. It can drink by changing the solid food into a thin liquid.

1. Find words in the passage that will complete these sentences:

- a) A glow-worm is really a kind of ____ .
- b) It is an insect with a light in its ____ .
- c) An ____ has six legs.
- d) 'The laboratory was too small, so the class did its practical work in two ____.'
- e) The glow-worm and the lion ____ other creatures for food.
- f) 'Your ____ of working is not very practical.'
- g) 'He hit his head on the wall as he fell, and was ____ for about a minute.
- h) 'The enemy made an ____ on the fort but could not capture it.'
- i) Water is a ____ and so is oil.
- j) When water freezes it turns into a ____ substance called ice.

2. Choose the right words to complete each sentence from the three choices given in brackets:

- a) The glow-worm is a (snail, beetle, wild animal).
- b) In the tail of the glow-worm there is a (red, pink, green) light.
- c) All insects have (six legs, red spots on their bodies, yellow manes).

- d) The glow-worm feeds on (flies, earth-worms, a kind of small snail).
- e) Glow-worms live on (solid food, water, solid substances that they turn into liquids).
- f) The back of the glow-worm is coloured (dark brown, light green, pink).
- g) The glow-worm has divisions in its (head, body, tail).
- h) When water freezes it becomes (oily, liquid, solid).

3. Put a or an before these words:

Insect, library, animal, island, zoo, area, mile, continent, hour, encyclopedia.

Section 3

Structural Items: The present perfect tense / The future tense with going to / The simple future tense (3C only)

3A. Will's Bicycle

Will's bicycle has a flat tyre. He cannot ride it. He has to repair a puncture. He does not need to pay the man at the bicycle shop to mend it. He can repair it himself. He has taken out the inner tube. He has tested it and has found the puncture. The test is easy. You get a bucket of water. You blow up the inner tube with a bicycle pump and put the tube into the water, bit by bit. You move the tube round till you see a stream of air bubbles coming up through the water. You mark the place where the air is coming out with a special pencil. Will has one of these pencils. His father has given him a repair outfit. The pencil is in the outfit. He has marked the place where the puncture is. When the inner tube is dry he is going to stick a rubber patch on the puncture. He is going to stick it on with rubber solution. There are some patches and a tube of rubber solution in the repair outfit. When Will has repaired his bicycle he is going to ride it again.

1. Find words in the passage that can complete these sentences:

- a) Bicycle wheels have rubber ____ round them.
- b) When a tyre has a ____ it goes flat.
- c) The ____ holds the air.
- d) To mend a puncture you have to stick a ____ on it with ____ .
- e) Will is going to blow up his tyre with a ____ .
- f) All the things he needs to mend the tyre are in a ____ .
- g) When you put the inner tube in water a stream of ____ comes up from the puncture.
- h) Will has ____ the puncture himself.

2. Answer these questions:

- a) Why can Will not ride his bicycle?
- b) How do you know when a tyre has a puncture?
- c) Who is going to mend the puncture?
- d) How do you find a puncture?
- e) Who has given Will the things to mend the puncture with?
- f) When you want to buy a set of these things, what do you ask for at the cycle shop?
- g) Why is Will waiting till The inner tube is dry?
- h) What has he marked the puncture with?

- i) What has he to do after he has mended the puncture, so that, he can ride his bicycle again?
- j) Is the rubber solution in a packet or in a tube?

3. Complete these sentences:

- a) Will ____ ride his bicycle.
- b) He does not ____ to take it to the bicycle shop.
- c) He ____ mend the puncture himself.
- d) He has ____ the inner tube.
- e) He has ____ it in a bucket of water.
- f) He has ____ the puncture.
- g) He ____ to stick a patch on the puncture.
- h) When he ____ up the tyre with a bicycle pump, he is ____ ride his bicycle again.

Section 4

Structural Item: The simple present tense

4A. Exports

Exports are either raw materials or manufactured goods. Raw materials are products of the land, such as cotton, timber or rubber. Some raw materials such as iron ore come from mines. These raw materials are often exported by the countries that produce them to other countries where they are made into manufactured goods.

Some countries produce food for export, for example meat, sugar, or cereals such as wheat and maize. These countries are agricultural countries. An agricultural country needs fertile land and a good climate. A cold, wet climate is not suitable for agriculture.

A country which produces manufactured goods is known as an industrialised country. An industrialised country cannot always produce enough food for its own needs. In this case it does not export foodstuffs, of course. It has to import them. It relies on exports of manufactured products and pays for imports with the money it earns from the exported goods.

1. Find words in the passage that can complete these sentences:

- a) A country's ____ are the goods it sells to other countries.
- b) An ____ country produces food.
- c) ____ land is needed for growing food.
- d) Countries with a warm ____ can grow food more easily than cold countries,
- e) Some ____ countries cannot grow all the food they need.

2. Answer these questions:

- a) What kind of land does an agricultural country need?
- b) What kinds of things are exported by an agricultural country?
- c) What are raw materials?
- d) What kind of country imports raw materials?
- e) Do industrialised countries always produce enough food for their own needs?
- f) How do industrialised countries pay for their imports?
- g) Is a warm climate or a cold climate better for agriculture?
- h) What kind of things do industrialised countries export?
- i) Is the country you live in an agricultural country or an industrialised country?
- j) Can you give the names of some foodstuffs grown by agricultural countries for export?

3. Are these statements right or wrong?

- a) No country can export manufactured goods.
- b) An industrialised country exports only food.
- c) Cereals and meat are foodstuffs.
- d) Cereals do not grow well on fertile land.
- e) Industrialised countries always produce enough food for their needs.
- f) A country without enough food has to import it.
- g) Some industrialised countries rely on their exports for food.
- h) Most of us earn money by doing work.
- i) We pay for goods with money.
- j) Countries earn money by their imports.

4. Fill the blanks with a, an or the, where necessary:

- a) have ____ older brother and ____ younger sister.
- b) ____ cotton is ____ raw material.
- c) I always drink ____ cup of ____ tea and eat ____ egg for ____ breakfast.
- d) ____ cold climate is not good for ____ agriculture.
- e) I want ____ ounce of ____ coffee and ____ pound of ____ sugar.

5. Complete the sentences below with suitable words from this list:

Can, cannot; do, does, do not, does not; have to, has to.

- a) Rubber and sugar ____ be grown in cold climates.
- b) A farmer ____ sell his meat and cereals to earn money.
- c) With the money he earns, the farmer ____ buy the seed to plant for next year's crop.
- d) A country with a good climate ____ produce food for export.
- e) Factories ____ rely on raw materials to produce manufactured goods.

Section 5

Structural Items: The simple present tense / The adverbs always, never, often, sometimes, usually / Passive voice, simple present (5C only)

5A. Advertising

Advertising has become a very specialised activity in modern times. In the business world of today, supply is usually greater than demand. There is great competition between different manufacturers of the same kind of product to persuade customers to buy their own particular brand. They always have to remind the consumer of the name and the qualities of their product. They do this by advertising. The manufacturer advertises in the newspapers and on posters. He sometimes pays for songs about his product in commercial radio programmes. He employs attractive sales-girls to distribute samples of it. He organises competitions, with prizes for the winners. He often advertises on the screens of local cinemas. Most important of all, in countries that have television he has advertisements put into programmes that will accept them. Manufacturers often spend large sums of money on advertisements. We buy a particular product because we think that it is the best. We usually think so because of the advertisements that say so. Some people never pause to ask themselves if the advertisements are telling the truth.

1. Answer these questions:

- a) How many kinds of advertisements are mentioned in the passage? What are they?
- b) Why do manufacturers spend so much money on advertising?
- c) What do sales-girls do?
- d) Which do you think more effective, giving out samples or paying for television advertisements? Say why.
- e) Do you think that we buy goods because they are advertised? Why do you think so (or not)?

2. Find words in the passage that give the meaning of these phrases:

- a) The activity of telling people about products for sale.
- b) The activity of providing things for sale.
- c) The need to buy things.
- d) The efforts of one person to do better than another person.
- e) Radio programmes that accept money from advertisers.
- f) Small portions of a product given out to the public.
- g) Something given to the person who does best in a competition.
- h) The name that a manufacturer gives to his own product.

3. Put the words in brackets into their proper places in these sentences:

- a) Customers find it hard to choose between one brand and another (sometimes).
- b) There are advertisements in the programmes of local cinemas (usually).
- c) I try to find the cheapest brands in the shops (always).
- d) People who believe the advertisements may find that they are not true (sometimes).
- e) Songs are used to advertise products on television (often).

4. Supply a, an or the where necessary:

A manufacturer who has ____ new product to sell usually advertises in ____ newspapers. ____ advertisement in a newspaper is cheaper than one on ____ television, but many ____ business men think that the television is more effective than either ____ newspapers or ____ commercial radio. Many people will buy ____ article of ____ food or clothing just because they have seen it advertised, but I always want to know if ____ advertisements are telling ____ truth.

Section 6

Structural Items: The simple present tense could, would (6C only)

6A. Gravity

The earth continuously spins in space. But we do not fall off the surface of the earth. We can move on it like flies walking on a tennis ball. Why don't we fall off? The earth contains an enormous amount of matter. Its mass is great. Every particle of matter on the earth pulls on every other particle of matter. We call this pulling force gravity. This force of gravity keeps us from falling off the earth.

1. Find words in the passage that can complete these sentences:

- a) The earth is a planet that ____ in space.
- b) We can move on the earth's ____ without falling ____.
- c) A ____ can walk on a tennis ____.
- d) There is a great mass of ____ in the earth.
- e) Every ____ of matter has a ____ force.
- f) We are kept from falling off the earth by the force of ____.

2. Fill each blank with the necessary word: from, in, of, on or to:

- a) The earth spins ____ space.
- b) There are 365 days ____ a year.
- c) A fly can walk ____ a tennis ball.
- d) Different kinds ____ plants grow ____ the surface ____ the earth.
- e) The distance ____ the moon ____ the earth is about 233,500 miles.

3. Are these statements right or wrong?

- a) The earth never stops spinning.
- b) A fly can only walk on a tennis ball.
- c) Particles of matter are always falling off the earth.
- d) The force of gravity stops people from falling off the earth.
- e) Each particle of matter pulls on all the other particles.

4. Read Passage 2B (The Sun's Family) again, then answer these questions:

- a) What are the names of the other planets besides the earth?
- b) Where are the earth and all the other planets moving?
- c) What does the earth do all the time as it goes round the sun?
- d) Why don't we fall off the earth?
- e) How many satellites does the earth have?

5. Column B below gives meanings for the words in Column A, but not in their correct order. Put each phrase in Column B opposite the word that it explains:

A	B
a) continuously	the pulling force of matter
b) enormous	a very small piece
c) to spin	without stopping
d) gravity	very large
e) a particle	to turn round and round very quickly

Section 7

Structural Items: *still* in affirmative sentences / *yet* in negative and interrogative sentences / *too...to* + infinitive / *enough...to* + infinitive.

7A. Martin Baker and his Family

Martin Baker is a bus driver. He lives in a small town with his wife and four children. His wife's father, Mr Butcher, lives with them too. He is too old to do any work. He sits in his chair by the fireside all day; but in summer, when it is warm enough to sit outside, he sometimes takes his chair into the garden.

Mr Baker has been very ill for over a month. He has been too ill to go to work. He cannot go to work yet. He is not well enough to go to work. He is still too weak to drive his bus.

Martin's eldest son is twenty-five. He teaches in a village school. He lives in the village because it takes too long to travel there every day from his father's house. The other children are not yet old enough to go out to work. They still go to school __except for the youngest daughter. She is only four and a half. She is still too young to go to school.

1. Find words in the passage to complete these sentences:

- a) Martin Baker has been ill and is too ____ to go back to work.
- b) Old Mr Butcher sits by the ____ all day to keep warm.
- c) Martin's ____ son teaches in a village school.
- d) The other children are too young to ____ ____ ____.
- e) The ____ daughter is only four and a half.

2. Answer these questions:

- a) How many people are living in Mr Baker's house?
- b) How many of Mr Baker's children go to school?
- c) How long has Mr Baker been away from work?
- d) Why does his eldest son live away from home?
- e) When does old Mr Butcher go out and sit in the garden?
- f) What was Mrs Baker called before she was married?

3. Fill the blanks with *enough* or *too*:

- a) The children go to school by bus because it would take ____ long to walk there.
- b) We haven't ____ money to go to the cinema.
- c) Mr Baker is not strong ____ to drive his bus.
- d) Nine o'clock is ____ early to go to bed.
- e) This tea is ____ hot to drink.

4. Fill the blanks with *still* or *yet*:

- a) Mr Baker is ____ too weak to go to work.
- b) The tea is too hot. I can't drink it ____.
- c) My sister ____ goes to school, but I am old enough to go out to work.
- d) You can't go to bed ____, because you haven't finished your homework.
- e) You ____ have quite a lot to do.

5. Look at these sentences:

This girl is **too young** to go to school.

This girl is not **old enough** to go to school.

Now rewrite the following sentences in the same manner:

- a) Mr Baker is too weak to drive a bus.
- b) He is too ill to go to work.
- c) Mr Baker is too poor to own a car.
- d) You are too small to wear these clothes.
- e) Those bananas are too bad to eat.

Section 8

Structural Items: Comparative and superlative forms...-**er than**,
more...than/ (the)...-**est** (the) **most**...

8A. Plants and their Life

Plants cannot live without water and light. The problem of water is most severe in the deserts. Some desert plants send their roots deep into the ground, to tap the water stored below, but the cactus usually has shallow roots. When it rains the cactus absorbs as much water as possible. It stores this water in its fleshy stems. Plants usually lose a lot of water by evaporation through their leaves. Therefore, desert plants have tougher leaves than other plants. Sometimes prickly spines cover these desert plants. Spines make the rate of evaporation slower.

All green plants must have light. Most trees and grasses grow best in full sunlight. But there are some plants that do not need much light. Full sunlight would kill them. For example, some water plants grow 450 feet below the surface of the water. At that depth the light is weaker than that of the full moon.

1. Answer these questions:

- a) What use are the spines on the leaves of a desert plant?
- b) If a plant sends its roots deep into the ground, why does it do so?
- c) What kind of land do cacti (cactuses) grow in?
- d) Do most plants grow better in the shade or in the light?
- e) Is moonlight stronger or weaker than sunlight?

2. Change the following sentences as in the example:

Example: A city is **busier than** a village.

Answer: A village is **not so busy as** a city.

- a) The earth is bigger than the moon.
- b) Cake is sweeter than bread.
- c) Electric lights are safer than candles.
- d) China is larger than Japan.
- e) Deserts are drier than fertile areas.

3. Fill the blanks in the sentences below with suitable phrases from this list:

higher than, harder than, the biggest, the best, the longest.

- a) Milk is ____ food for babies.
- b) Iron is ____ wood.
- c) The Nile and the Amazon are ____ rivers in the world.
- d) I am hungry, so I want ____ cake that you can give me.
- e) A plane can fly ____ a bird.

4. Choose the correct word or phrase from those in brackets to complete each sentence:

- a) Cacti grow (on mountain tops, in deserts, by river banks).
- b) Plants need (only light, only water, both light and water) to keep them alive.
- c) Moonlight is (better than, not so good as, just as good as) sunlight for most plants.
- d) The cactus stores water in (fleshy stems, tough leaves, deep roots).
- e) Evaporation is caused by too much (cold, heat, light).

5. Fill the blanks with *a*, *an* or *the*:

- a) Most secondary schools have ____ reference library.
- b) A vegetarian animal is called ____ herbivore. ____ largest herbivore is ____ elephant.
- c) ____ cactus is ____ desert plant.
- d) A family of bees is called ____ colony. ____ drones are ____ males of ____ colony.
- e) Venus is ____ beautiful planet, perhaps ____ most beautiful of all ____ planets. It has ____ very soft light.

Section 9

Structural Items: may, ought to.

Note: may is used in two ways:

1. To give or refuse permission.

e.g. May I have another piece of cake, please?

Yes, you may.

(No, you may not.) (9A)

2. To express a possibility.

e.g. The doctor may be able to see you at 11 o'clock.

She may not get your invitation in time to come to the party tonight. (9B)

This second use is not very common in questions. If one were to ask the question to which the first of these examples would be an answer, it would be better to say something like 'Do you think the doctor will be able to see me at 11 o'clock?'

Passage 9C has examples of both uses of may.

9A. Our School Library

We have a big, well-equipped library in our school. There is a librarian in charge of it. Pupils of the school may borrow books from this library, but they may not lend them to others without the permission of the librarian. Pupils may borrow two books at a time. They may keep these books for any length of time up to a fortnight. If they do not return them by the end of this period, they may be refused permission to borrow any more.

The library has a reference section. The books in this section may not be taken away. There are also magazines and newspapers in the library. These, like the reference books, may not be borrowed.

There are a number of rules for behaviour in the library. The librarian thinks that students ought to put back the books in their correct places on the shelves. They ought to leave the magazines and newspapers in good order. They ought to treat the books carefully and keep them in good condition. Students may not talk in the library or disturb others there. They ought also to keep reasonably quiet when they are passing along outside the library.

1. According to the passage, are these statements true or untrue?

- a) Pupils may lend their library books to others.
- b) Borrowers may keep books as long as they like.
- c) Books in the reference section may not be taken away.
- d) Books may not be taken down from the shelves.
- e) Readers ought to put books and magazines back in the places where they found them.
- f) Nobody may talk in the library.
- g) Students ought not to be noisy near the library.
- h) Students who break the rules about returning books to the library may lose the right to borrow any more.

2. Fill the blanks with ought to or ought not to, to give a sensible meaning:

- a) We ____ keep our classrooms clean.
- b) Children ____ help their parents.
- c) We ____ keep flies away from food.
- d) Students ____ put library books back in the wrong places.
- e) Borrowers ____ treat the books badly or lose them.

3. Find words in the passage that can complete these sentences:

- a) A librarian is a person who is ____ a library.
- b) The books in the library are kept on ____.
- c) Always try to keep the books that you borrow in ____.
- d) You need not stop talking entirely, but I want you to keep ____ quiet while I am speaking on the telephone.
- e) Students may not keep their library books for longer than a ____.

4. Answer these questions:

- a) Why do you think that borrowers may not keep their books for longer than a fortnight?
- b) Why must students put books back in their proper places?
- c) Why does the librarian not allow students to talk in the library?
- d) Why may students not take reference books away?
- e) Why ought borrowers to treat their library books carefully?

Section 10

Structural Items: The simple past / The past progressive / While.

10A. A Narrow Escape

It was fine and warm one afternoon, and Will decided to go for a bicycle ride in the country. He was enjoying the sunshine and the peaceful roads, and when he came to a steep hill he let his bicycle run down it much too fast. But there was a sharp bend at the bottom of the hill. When he was nearly there, a dog rushed out of a farmyard, barking and jumping up at him.

Will put his brakes on. He managed not to hit the dog, but he was going too fast to get round the bend safely. The bicycle ran across the road and hit the bank at the other side. Fortunately, no vehicle was passing, so there was no danger of a collision. As Will was picking himself up, the farmer came out. When he saw that there was no damage, he brought Will back to the farmhouse and gave him a glass of fresh milk.

Will was soon ready to go on with his ride. 'All's well that ends well,' he said to the farmer when they wished each other goodbye.

1. Answer these questions:

- a) Why did Will decide to go for a bicycle ride?
- b) What did he do when he came to the steep hill?
- c) How did Will try to stop his bicycle?
- d) Why did Will hit the bank at the side of the road?
- e) When did the farmer come out?
- f) Why did Will and his bicycle escape damage?
- g) Where did the farmer take Will?
- h) What did the farmer do to show that he was sorry for the accident?
- i) What did Will say to show that no harm had been done?
- j) Do you think the accident was the farmer's fault? Give reasons.

2. Write out these sentences, putting the verbs in brackets into their correct past form:

Example: While Will (mend) his puncture it (start) to rain.

Answer: While Will was mending his puncture it started to rain.

Example: Will (mend) his puncture when it (start) to rain.

Answer: Will was mending his puncture when it started to rain.

- a) Will (have) a narrow escape while he (ride) his bicycle.
- b) While he (go) down the hill a dog (rush) at him.
- c) He (put) his brakes on when he (see) the bend just in front of him.
- d) He (go) too fast when he (reach) the bend.
- e) While he (get) up the farmer (come) along the road.
- f) He (sit) and (rest) when the farmer (bring) him a glass of fresh milk.

3. Fill the blanks with off or on:

- a) Will set ____ for a ride ____ his bicycle.
- b) He went ____ a road that went down a steep hill.
- c) There was a dog ____ the road.
- d) Will hit the bank covered with grass ____ the other side of the road.
- e) He fell ____ his bicycle when it ran up the bank.

4. Choose words from the passage to complete these sentences:

- a) My bicycle went very ____ down the hill because the hill was ____ .
- b) I like going for rides in the ____ , where there are no houses or shops.
- c) The farmer's dog ran out of the ____ .
- d) You must have good ____ if you want to be able to stop your car quickly.

- e) We cannot drive fast along this road, because there are a lot of ____ in it.
- f) A ____ has been built over the stream so that people can cross it.
- g) Grass was growing on the ____ on both sides of the road.
- h) There was no fear of a ____ when Will's bicycle went across the road, because no ____ was passing.
- i) My car suffered serious ____ when I had a puncture and ran into a wall.
- j) People who live in towns can never get ____ fresh from the cow.